

OSF × Andela Hackathon 2026 — Safety, Reporting & Protection

# Ekyama

Speak safely. Be heard.

An anonymous reporting and support tool for survivors of abuse in Uganda — built for men and women alike.

## THE PROBLEM

# Male survivors have nowhere obvious to go

Uganda's GBV support tools and services are built almost entirely around women and children. Male survivors of rape, defilement and domestic abuse are left out — practically and legally.

### The legal gap

Uganda's Penal Code (s.123) defines rape as an offence against a woman or girl. A male survivor cannot report a sexual assault as "rape" under that section.

### The fear

Same-sex assault often falls under s.145, the same statute criminalising same-sex conduct — so reporting can risk exposing the survivor himself.

### The result

Stigma plus legal risk plus no clear pathway means many male survivors — and many women too — simply don't report at all.

WHO IT'S FOR

## Three people Ekyama is built around

### A male survivor

Of domestic abuse or sexual assault, who may not know any service exists for him and fears not being believed, or legal exposure.

### A female survivor

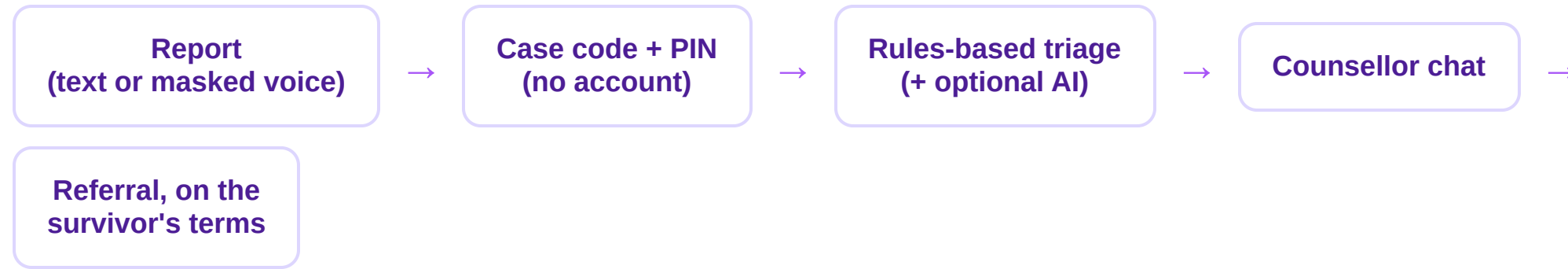
Of domestic abuse, rape or defilement-related concerns — including reporting on behalf of a child.

### A counsellor

Triaging incoming reports by urgency, responding without ever seeing a survivor's identity unless the survivor chooses to share it.

## THE SOLUTION

**Report → be heard → get a real next step**



No registration. No forced disclosure. A human counsellor is always the first step — police involvement is the survivor's choice, never the default.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

Not a mockup — the real, working app

Ekyama

Detailed view

Uganda

English

Quick exit

Tell us what happened

Write in your own words, or record your voice — we will disguise it before anything is saved. You do not have to give your name.

This happened to

me

someone I know

What happened

My partner hit me last night and threatened me. This has happened before.

Phone numbers, emails and ID numbers you type are removed automatically before saving.

District (optional, helps us point you to nearby help)

Or record your voice instead

Your voice will be pitch-shifted in your browser before it's saved. The original recording never leaves this device.

Start recording

Submit report

Reporting — text, PII auto-scrubbed live

Ekyama

Detailed view

Uganda

English

Quick exit

Cases (1)

high

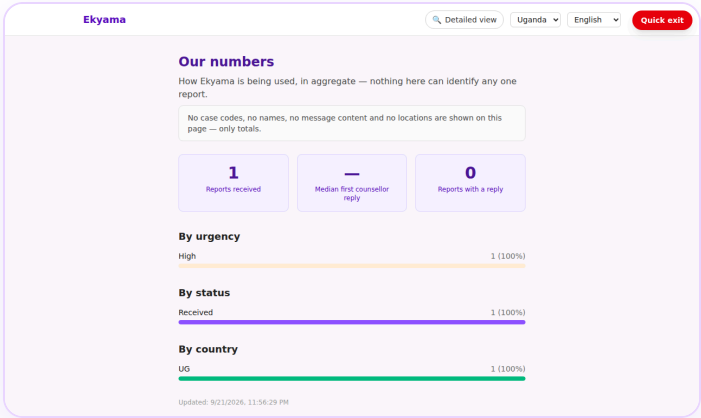
EKY-FK3JN07

UG

Kampala

RECEIVED

Counsellor console — sorted by urgency



Public transparency stats

## Built for real conditions, not a demo

- **Voice masking on-device** — recordings are pitch-shifted in the browser; the original never leaves the phone.
- **Automatic PII scrubbing** — phone numbers, emails and ID numbers are stripped before anything is saved.
- **Sourced, dated information** — every hotline and legal note shows where it came from and when it was checked; unverified entries are labelled, never presented as fact.
- **Low-data mode** and a **quick-exit** button on every page.
- **English, Luganda, Kiswahili** — with a country-pack architecture so a second country is a data file, not a rewrite.

## WHERE AI FITS

# AI assists counsellors. It never talks to survivors.

*"A rules-based floor always runs first. An optional AI pass can raise urgency for a counsellor's attention — it can never lower what the rules already flagged, and it never generates a message a survivor reads."*

### Rules-based triage

Always on. Flags danger signals: weapons, "right now", a child involved, and more — zero dependencies, zero API key required.

### Optional free-tier AI

Sharpens the counsellor's brief. Fails silently back to rules if unavailable — the demo can't break on this path.

# How AI was used to build Ekyama

- The problem, the target users, and the core design decisions (counsellor-first routing, no registration, on-device voice masking, country-pack architecture) came from the author first, then were built out with Claude as a coding and research assistant.
- Claude scaffolded the Next.js app, wrote the API routes, the rules-based triage engine, the PII-scrubbing and voice-masking code, the i18n dictionaries, and the country-pack data — with a research pass to find and cite the Uganda and Kenya legal/hotline sources.
- Every AI-written piece was tested end-to-end before being kept: submit → triage → counsellor reply → survivor sees reply, PII scrubbing, wrong-PIN/wrong-token rejection, a synthetic pitch-shift test for the voice masking, and headless-browser checks for the country switcher, offline mode and the USSD flow.
- When the author found two real bugs after testing (voice masking not audible, a dark-mode styling bug), Claude diagnosed and fixed both with the author reviewing each change — documented in full in `docs/AI_USAGE.md`.

UNIQUENESS

# What sets Ekyama apart

| Feature       | Typical GBV reporting tools                 | Ekyama                                                                                  |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Who it's for  | Framed around women and children            | Men and women, explicitly                                                               |
| First contact | Often routes straight to police/institution | Human counsellor first, always                                                          |
| Legal framing | Generic                                     | Country-specific — even catches Kenya vs. Uganda differing on who the rape law protects |
| Trust         | Static info, no provenance                  | Sourced + dated on every entry                                                          |
| Scale         | Hard-coded to one country                   | Two country packs shipped, switchable live                                              |

## Two things most hackathon entries only put on a roadmap slide

### Two countries, live today

Switch the header dropdown from Uganda to Kenya and the help directory, legal notes and even the available languages update everywhere at once — all from one JSON data file, no code change. It surfaced a real finding: Kenya's rape law is gender-neutral, Uganda's is not. The app now says so, instead of assuming one legal picture fits every country it expands to.

### Works on a feature phone, demonstrably

Roughly 1 in 3 phones in the region is still a feature phone. /ussd-demo is a keypad-and-screen simulator that calls the exact same report and case-lookup APIs as the web app — not a mockup. A report submitted through 2 keypad presses shows up in the counsellor console exactly like a web submission. What's left for production is a telco gateway contract, not a rebuild.

Plus: the app installs to a home screen and keeps working offline for the pages survivors need most — verified by a real service worker, not a manifest alone.

# Trustworthy isn't just a claim — it's checkable and it's reachable

## A public numbers page

/stats shows real, live totals — reports received, the breakdown by urgency, status and country, and the median time to a counsellor's first reply — computed straight from the case database. No case codes, no narrative text, no locations, no per-case timestamps: only aggregates. An institution's responsiveness should be visible even when no individual report can be.

## A simple view for every literacy level

One toggle swaps the home, report and help pages into large icons, tap-to-call hotline cards and icon buttons instead of paragraphs and radio labels — the same underlying flow and data, just far less reading required. The preference is remembered on the device, so it isn't a separate stripped-down app to maintain.

## A low-friction first step for the least-served survivors

Piloted with an organisation like MOHRAU or the Uganda Police Child & Family Protection Unit as the receiving counsellor team, Ekyama gives male survivors — one of the least-served groups in the region's GBV response — a safe first point of contact, and gives every survivor visibility into what happens after they report.

### **Next: a real telco gateway**

Wire /ussd - demo's proven flow to a live USSD short code via a provider like Africa's Talking.

### **Next: native-speaker review**

Of Luganda strings, plus more local languages and a third country pack.

### **Next: per-counsellor accounts**

Replacing the shared demo token with real accounts and audit logging.